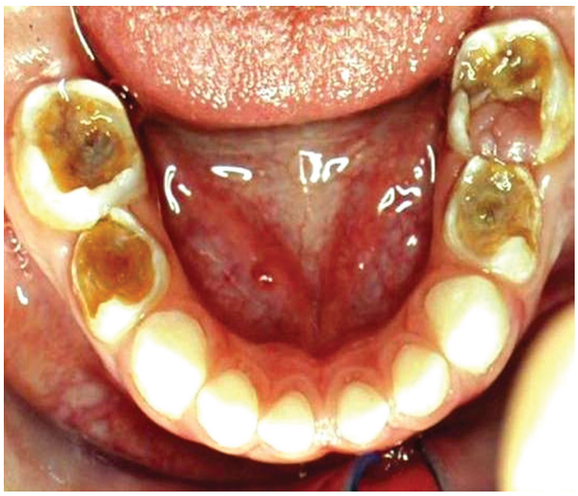


Figure 9.4 Defective teeth formation

9.2.3. Sodium

Sodium is the predominant cation of the extra cellular fluid. It is taken in the diet as sodium chloride.

Functions:

1. Sodium ion is mainly associated with chloride and bicarbonate in the regulation of acid-base equilibrium.

2. It maintains osmotic pressure of the body fluids and thus protects the body against excessive fluid loss.

3. Sodium ions are involved in the transmission of nerve impulses.

4. It plays an important role in the absorption of glucose and nutrients from small intestine by active transport.

5. Sodium ions are also involved in heart function.

Sources:



Figure 9.5 sources of sodium

Sodium is widely distributed in animal sources than plants. However, major source is common salt used in cooking. Cauliflowers, carrot and milk are also good sources of sodium.

Absorption and excretion:

Sodium is completely absorbed from the gastro intestinal tract by active transport. Normal diet contains about 5-10 grams of sodium as sodium chloride. The same amount of sodium is excreted daily through urine and sweat.

Unit 9.indd 234 21-05-2018 15:12:10